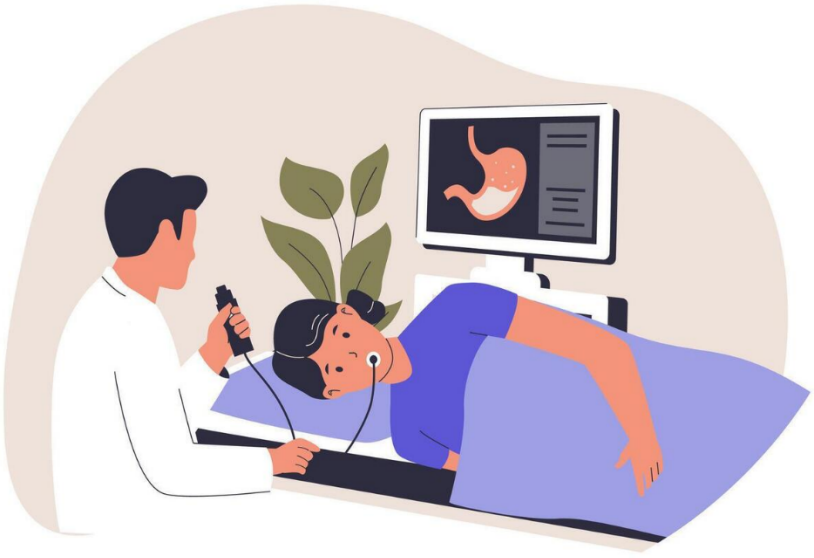
This social story was developed by Dr. Mojdeh Mostafavi, a pediatric fellow in gastroenterology at Mass General Hospital for Children. Learn more by visiting https://www.massgeneral.org/children/gastroenterology

MassGeneral Hospital for Children

Getting an Endoscopy



801 Massachusetts Ave, 7th Floor
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This story is about how I can get an endoscopy. If I feel nervous, I can:

- Think of something that makes me happy
- Ask someone to hold my hand
- Use calming exercises like counting



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To get ready for my test, I will need to have a special drink. The drink will help me poop. My belly might feel different, but it will not hurt.





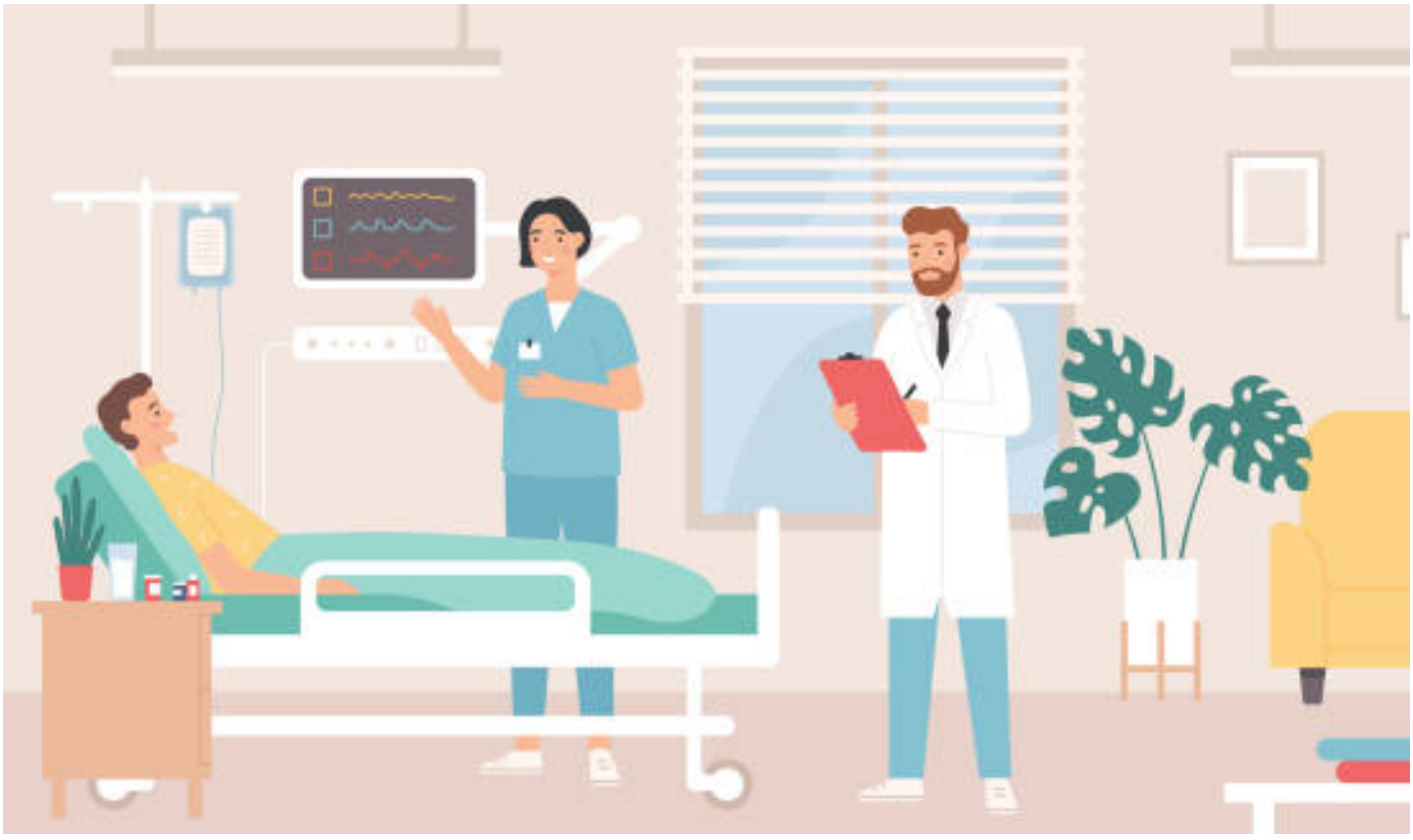
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In the morning, I am going to wake up, but I am not going to eat or drink. I will still be able to have medicine.



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Then I will go to the hospital, check in, and wait until the nurses are ready to help me get ready in the examination room.



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The nurse in the room will check my weight, and after that I will take off all my clothes. They will give me a hospital gown to wear, and I may feel cold. If I am cold, I can use a warm blanket.





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Then the nurse will check my temperature. They may touch my face or arm with the thermometer, but it will not hurt. If I am nervous or uncomfortable, I can count to 20.



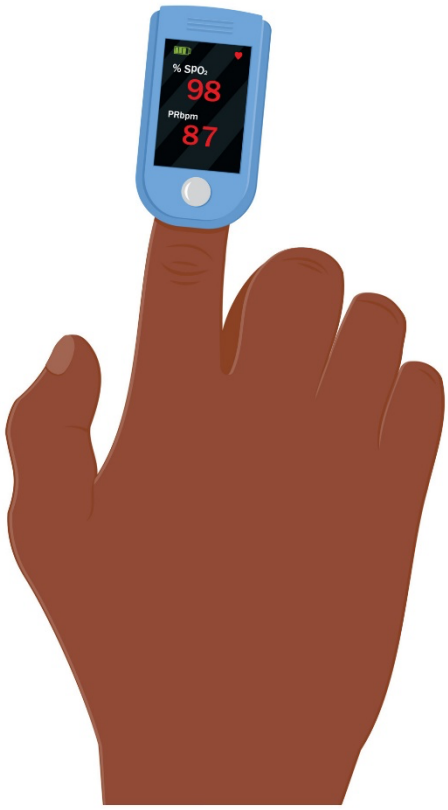
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The nurse will check my blood pressure after taking my temperature. They will wrap a band around my arm that will give me a big squeeze. It will not hurt. If I am nervous or uncomfortable, I can count to 20.



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The nurse will check my oxygen after by putting a clip on my finger that shines a red light. It will not hurt. If I am nervous or uncomfortable, I can count to 20.



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While I'm waiting, it is okay to feel nervous or scared. I will remind myself that I am safe and that there are nurses, doctors, and a child life specialist to all help take care of me. They will answer my questions, and the doctor may give me medicine to help me relax.





To get ready for my test, I may go under anesthesia with an IV. For this, I will get an IV, which is a special straw that goes in my hand or arm. The doctor can give me special water and medicine through my IV. I am safe while using an IV.



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The nurse will push on my hand or arm. They will wrap a rubber band around my arm- it will feel tight. Then the nurse will clean my arm with a swab- this will feel cold and wet.





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The nurse will put the special straw in my arm using a needle. This will feel like a poke or sting, and it may hurt a little bit. If I am nervous or uncomfortable, I can count to 20. When this is done, the nurse will take the needle away.



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The nurse will put tape on the special tube. I will see blood coming out of my body, but my body will make more blood. I am safe.



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The nurse will connect the IV to special water or medicine. This will make me feel better! I will not touch or pull on my IV.



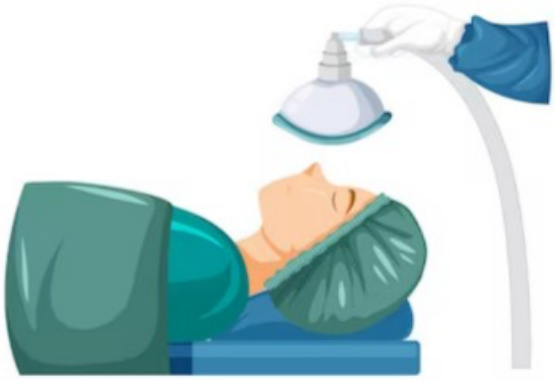
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I will go to the endoscopy room. There will be lots of machines in the room. It is okay to feel nervous or scared, but I will remind myself that I am safe and that the nurses and doctors will help me be comfortable. I will get medicine to make me fall asleep, and the doctor will do the endoscopy test. The endoscopy will not hurt.



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I may go under anesthesia by using a mask. For this, the doctor will give me a mask to put on my nose and mouth. It will feel squishy, and it will smell funny. I will take deep breaths in and out. I am safe.





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The doctor will give me medicine to wake me up. When I wake up, I may feel funny or tired. This will get better! The nurse will give me a drink and a snack.









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When my doctor says it is OK, I can go home! My throat might feel sore. I can have cold food and drinks. My throat will get better soon.



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I did a great job getting my endoscopy!



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